

Deep-M Effort (NQ)

Indicators & Analysis / Deep Indicators | advanced | 4 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | July 20, 2026

Deep-M Effort (NQ) is a proprietary indicator designed by the DeepCharts team specifically for Nasdaq futures (NQ). It reads the order book and shades zones that mark the path of least resistance: purple where the easier path is down (bearish pressure), green where it is up (bullish pressure), plus an integrated dynamic moving average for directional confluence.

It ships pre-optimized and pre-configured — you do not tune its core logic, only its appearance and alerts.

What it is

Deep-M Effort translates order-book pressure into colored zones directly on the chart. Rather than making you interpret raw depth or delta, it answers "which way is the market's path of least resistance right now?" The built-in moving average adapts dynamically and confirms directional bias when price and zones agree.

Warning: Two hard requirements. First, the indicator works exclusively on a **40 Range** chart — set the chart to Range bars with parameter 40 **before** applying it. Second, it is optimized for **NQ** only. On any other chart type or symbol it will not work as designed. Core logic settings should not be modified — only visual customization is supported.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] NQ 40 Range chart with Deep-M Effort applied — green bullish-pressure zones and purple bearish-pressure zones visible around price, with the integrated moving average line running through the chart
deep-m-effort-nq-chart.png

When to use it

- You trade NQ and want an at-a-glance read of order-book pressure without interpreting raw depth yourself.
- You want a pre-optimized tool with no parameters to tune — apply it and read it.
- You use confluence between a directional filter (the integrated moving average) and pressure zones for entries.
- You trade Range charts and want an orderflow layer built natively for that bar type.

Quick start

1. Set your chart to **40 Range** bars first — the indicator only functions on this chart type (see Chart Display Options (Bar Styles, Sessions, Countdown) for changing bar types).
2. Load the **NQ** symbol.
3. Open the **Indicators** menu, find **Deep-M Effort (NQ)** and add it to the workspace.
4. Leave the core logic untouched. If you want, adjust colors, opacity and the moving-average style, and set up alerts.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Deep-M Effort (NQ) settings dialog showing the visual customization options — Bid Color, Ask Color, Opacity, Line Width, and the Moving Average section with Auto Color and Line Style controls
deep-m-effort-settings.png

How to read it

- **Green zones** — the path of least resistance is up: bullish pressure in the order book. Expect upward movement to meet less resistance while price holds these zones.
- **Purple zones** — the path of least resistance is down: bearish pressure.

- **The moving average** — a dynamic directional filter. The strongest reads come from confluence: price above the moving average while green zones dominate is an aligned bullish picture; price below it inside purple zones is aligned bearish. Zones against the moving-average side are counter-pressure and warrant more caution.
- **Zone transitions** — when the dominant zone color flips, the book's easier path has changed; treat prior-direction trades with tighter management.

Settings reference

Only visual customization, labels and alerts are user-adjustable.

Visual settings

Setting	What it does
Bid Color	Appearance of the bearish (purple) pressure zones.
Ask Color	Appearance of the bullish (green) pressure zones.
Opacity	Zone transparency.
Line Width	Zone border thickness.

Moving average

Setting	What it does
Color / Color 2	Primary and secondary moving-average colors.
Auto Color	None or Slope — automatic coloring based on the moving average's slope.
Line Style	Solid or Dashed .
Width	Moving-average line thickness.
Name	Custom naming for the line.

Labels and alerts

Setting	What it does
Labels	Show or hide name and value labels.
Alerts	Custom alert sounds, messages and popup notifications for indicator events.

Tips and common mistakes

- **"It shows nothing"** is almost always one of the two requirements: the chart is not a 40 Range chart, or the symbol is not NQ. Fix the chart type first.
- **Do not modify core logic.** The indicator arrives pre-optimized; only the visual, label and alert settings listed above are supported for change.
- **Use Auto Color = Slope** on the moving average if you want the trend read to be visible at a glance without checking the line's direction.
- **Confluence over signals.** Zones alone are context, not entries — the tool is strongest when zone color, the moving average and your own orderflow read (for example Deep Stats) agree.

Related articles

- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Chart Display Options (Bar Styles, Sessions, Countdown)

- Moving Average
- Deep Stats
- Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
- How to Change the Layout of Indicators